MICHAEL BASSEY

CYBERSECURITY ENGINEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Engineer with hands-on experience across Application security, Network security, IT security, and Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT). Proficient in SAST and DAST methodologies, having identified and remediated 50+ vulnerabilities and reduced attack surface by 40% across client systems and APIs. Skilled at translating complex security findings into clear, actionable recommendations for engineering teams. Currently expanding expertise into DevOps and DevSecOps practices.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Security Domains: Application Security, API Security, Network Security, Penetration Testing, Vulnerability assessment and management, Identity & Access Management (IAM), Authentication & Access Control (RBAC), Incident Response, Risk Analysis & Remediation

Tools & Technologies: Nmap, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Metasploit framework, Snort, Nessus, Wireshark, SQLMap, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Python, Kali Linux, SAST, DAST

Additional: IT & Systems Support, DevOps & DevSecOps (in progress)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Engineer — September 2025 – Present

DefComm Solutions

- Conducted application, network, and cloud security assessments across multiple client systems, identifying and remediating 50+ vulnerabilities.
- Performed Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT) on web applications, APIs, and infrastructure, reducing the potential attack surface by 40%.
- Assessed and secured APIs by identifying weaknesses in authentication, authorization, and data exposure.
- Implemented SAST and DAST techniques to detect and remediate critical security flaws prior to deployment.
- Partnered with development teams to remediate vulnerabilities and strengthen overall security posture.
- Administered the company's admin dashboard, managing access control and permissions for 500+ users.
- Launched and managed an internal bug bounty program, coordinating 30+ external testers to maintain up-to-date security standards.
- Verified 100% compliance with security design requirements prior to client delivery.

Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Tester — August 2025 – Present

Silex Secure Labs

- Delivered IT support that maintained secure, reliable systems, reducing downtime and security incidents by 30%.
- Performed in-depth security testing on web applications and APIs, uncovering 15+ authentication and authorization weaknesses.
- Tested role-based access controls (RBAC) to detect privilege escalation and horizontal/vertical access bypass scenarios.
- Analyzed application logic to identify input validation flaws and business logic vulnerabilities.
- Collaborated with engineering teams to improve secure authentication flows and strengthen authorization mechanisms.
- Performed black-box penetration testing on a client insurance platform, simulating real-world external attacker conditions to uncover vulnerabilities in authentication, session management, and data handling without prior access to source code or internal architecture.

Bug Bounty Researcher **January 2024 – Present**

HackerOne Platform

- Performing independent vulnerability assessments and ethical hacking engagements across multiple private and public programs on HackerOne
- Identifying and responsibly disclosing security flaws such as Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), Broken Access Control (BAC), Insecure Direct Object References (IDOR) and Server Misconfigurations.
- Conducting in-depth reconnaissance and target enumeration using Amass, Shodan, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, and ffuf to uncover hidden endpoints, subdomains, and misconfigured assets
- Continuously enhancing technical expertise in web application security, API testing and cloud misconfiguration detection through hands-on bug bounty challenges

Cybersecurity & VAPT Intern **January 2024 – August 2025**

CFSS | The Red Users | Prodigy InfoTech | Hacktify

- Gained hands-on experience with industry-standard security tools, including Nmap, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Metasploit, Nikto, Wireshark, SQLMap, and Kali Linux.
- Executed penetration tests that identified vulnerabilities including XSS, SQL injection, and authentication/authorization misconfigurations.
- Conducted encryption and firewall configuration reviews to maintain confidentiality and mitigate data exposure risks.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Genetics and Biotechnology **Graduated August 2025**

University of Calabar, Calabar, Cross River State, Nigeria

Ethical Hacking & Penetration Testing Bootcamp **2022 – 2023**

Zero to Hero Mastery

Key Projects

- **Web Application Black Box Security Testing**

Performed black-box penetration testing on a client insurance platform, simulating real-world external attacker conditions to uncover vulnerabilities in authentication, session management, and data handling without prior access to source code or internal architecture.

- **API Security Assessment**

Performed security testing on APIs, assessing authentication, authorization, input validation, and data exposure risks.

- **Security Architecture & Hardening**

Designed and implemented a defense-in-depth security architecture, including access controls, endpoint protection, network segmentation, and system hardening to improve overall security posture.

- **Security Awareness & Phishing Simulation Program**

Developed and delivered cybersecurity awareness training, phishing simulations, and secure computing guidelines to improve employee security awareness and reduce human-related risks.

- **Bug Bounty Program Development & Coordination**

Hosted and coordinated a bug bounty program involving 50+ ethical hackers to identify and responsibly disclose security vulnerabilities. Managed vulnerability intake, validation, severity assessment, remediation tracking, and communication between security researchers and stakeholders. Contributed to improving the organization's security posture through structured vulnerability disclosure and risk management processes.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified API Hacking Expert (CAPIE)
- Certified Cybersecurity Educator Professional (CCEP)
- Multicloud Network Associate
- Cloud Security and Audit Fundamentals